

The delivery lady?

You know it when, after a flight, you decide to take an Uber instead of a bus. Or when you order food home instead of cooking. You know the classic, the why and when everyone does it. At least for me, the ride home was the simplest decision of my whole trip. I mean, I've already had a rough week there, so why would I want to torture myself on a bus for another hour on top of the 1.5-hour flight and 4 hours at the airport?

I got home after my time in Calgary, unpacked (that is, if you count opening the suitcase to suffice as an instance of unpacking), took a hot shower, and straight onto the bed I went. I planned to skip meals because I wasn't in the mood, and it is already 7:30 pm. But that side of me couldn't bear to lie still with the YouTube shorts until I fell asleep. So I did something that most would do: I looked for a deal on Uber Eats, in a typical broke student lifestyle.

After a while, I ordered the buy-one-get-one salmon poke bowl deal and saw myself in a 30-minute wait; everything seemed to have lined up perfectly. I would get the bowl at eight, finish it, and go to sleep, in an effort to fix my horrible sleep schedule. But I waited and waited; 30 minutes of scrolling passed. I opened the app, and my delivery lady had only gotten to the place, so I was like, no big deal, the night was still young, and I wasn't particularly hungry either. Yet another 30 minutes passed, and to my surprise, why was she still there? I tried everything to reach her, but nothing worked. I waited until 9 pm, and nothing happened. My mind just exploded with thoughts of why that delivery lady stayed in one place. There were a few theories: the first went something like this, "The delivery lady's phone just ran out of battery." This was most likely the reason, to be honest. Second one I came up with: "She dropped my food and didn't know what to do". So, being God's soldier myself, I put on some layers and headed out into the freezing night, believing that he would reward me with a favour for helping an old delivery lady on a random weekday.

But when I got on the bus, I started forming a few more theories. One was that the lady ate my food. I don't even know how I got there. No way someone would eat a buy-one-get-one salmon poke bowl deal as a delivery person on a random Monday night. Still, the idea stuck longer than it should have. Then my mind jumped to something worse: that she got robbed, and when I arrived, I would have to deal with it. Like, no way I would be able to scare anyone off to save anyone. Another idea was that she collapsed from a heart attack. I was already too deep into this mission

to back away. Who knows? Maybe the thief has already left, and everything would turn out to be okay.

So I hopped off the bus, opened the Uber app, and tracked her down to a parking area near the restaurant. My adrenaline was so high that I felt like I unlocked some kind of sixth sense. I scanned every car, every corner. Then, I heard a noise, probably just a pipe, but for a moment, I really thought I was about to do a 1v9.

However, I found nothing. And somehow I still got nervous, heart beating fast.

Accepting defeat, I walked back toward the restaurant, and just as I reached the door, my phone rang. It was the restaurant calling to inform me about the delivery. I knocked, and finally, someone handed me the food. Turns out there was also another college kid around my age who had been waiting an hour because of the same delivery lady.

On my way back to the bus station, all I could think about was where she went. How could a person just disappear like that? And then I saw a girl from the restaurant, walking beside me, presumably towards the station. I thought about saying hi, but I didn't. I kept walking, hoping that I wouldn't come off as some sort of creep. At the time, I was still reminiscing about that one girl, whom I met a long time ago, like an unfinished story that I never got closure on.

Then I looked down at the food in my hands and wondered if this was ever the reward I imagined. Earlier, I had told myself that God would put me on his good side for helping that delivery lady, somehow, after this sequence of bad luck. I was never the kind of person who did good deeds expecting something in return. But that day, I guess things just got too much over the week. At first, I thought the reward was not the food. Maybe it was the chance to talk to that girl, and I did not take it.

So now I am wondering if I am also a missing delivery guy who went missing in the moment. Waiting for something to happen, even when the opportunity is already standing right next to me. But if this is really God's work, I knew would feel that push again, somehow in me.